

Radiology Terminology Glossary

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Purpose

A reference glossary of common terms used across radiology screens, workflows, and documentation.

Terms

Term	Definition
Contrast Medium	A substance administered to enhance the visibility of internal structures on imaging.
Laterality	Designation of the left or right side of a paired body structure.
Modality	The imaging technique used, such as X-ray, CT, MRI, or ultrasound.
Attenuation	The reduction in intensity of an imaging signal as it passes through tissue.
Field of View	The area captured by an imaging acquisition.
Slice Thickness	The thickness of each cross-sectional image in a CT or MRI series.
STAT Order	An order requiring immediate priority handling.
Impression	The radiologist's summarized conclusion at the end of a report.
Addendum	A formal amendment to a finalized report.
Comparison Study	A prior imaging study used as a reference point for the current study.
Nephrogenic Systemic Fibrosis	A rare condition of concern with certain contrast agents in patients with impaired renal function.
PACS	Picture Archiving and Communication System, used to store and retrieve medical images.
Series	A set of related images acquired during a single imaging study.
Protocol	A standardized set of acquisition parameters for a given clinical indication.
Critical Finding	An unexpected imaging result requiring urgent communication to the care team.

Reference Visual (Synthetic)

SYNTHETIC PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL RADIOGRAPH

